

walgBaseBackupDelayed, WALGBaseBackupFailed

Overview

- walgBaseBackupDelayed alert indicates that the `base_backup` for WAL-G has not finished in a certain amount of time.
- WALGBaseBackupFailed means the most recent `base_backup` has failed.
- This can be due to load on the database servers, network conditions, or problems with GCS.
- This is not a user impacting alert.
- When this alert fires, it is expected that the recipient of the alert will check in on the `base_backup` and try to determine what has interrupted or failed the backup.

Services

- Service Overview
- Team that owns the service: Production Engineering : Database Reliability

Metrics

walgBaseBackupDelayed

- walgBaseBackupDelayed fires if the most recent `base_backup` is older than 30 hours.
- This is recorded via the `gitlab_com:last_walg_successful_basebackup_age_in_hours` recording rule.

WALGBaseBackupFailed

- walgBaseBackupDelayed fires if the most recent `base_backup` is older than 30 hours.
- This is determined by the metric `gitlab_job_failed{resource="walg-basebackup", type!~".+logical.+", env="gprd"} == 1`

Alert Behavior

- This alert can be silenced if the process is determined to be running and actually working. It shouldn't be silenced for longer than the expected time to finish the backup.
- This alert is expected to be rare.

Severities

- The severity of this alert is generally going to be a `~severity::4`.

- There is no user impact at all. The impact will be in the amount of time it would take to recover should we need to do so.

Verification

- Prometheus Query for Alert

Recent changes

- Recent Patroni Production Change/Incident Issues
- Recent chef-repo Changes
- Recent k8s-workloads Changes

Troubleshooting

- Check `/var/log/wal-g/wal-g_backup_push.log` and/or `/var/log/wal-g/wal-g_backup_push.log.1` on patroni nodes. Unfortunately WAL-G logs are not sent to Kibana at this time.
- This will give you information on what is happening. A finished backup will look something like this:

```
<13>Sep  2 00:00:01 backup.sh: INFO: 2021/09/02 08:20:54.669692 Finished writing part 1
<13>Sep  2 00:00:01 backup.sh: INFO: 2021/09/02 08:20:56.337685 Wrote backup with name
<13>Sep  2 00:00:01 backup.sh: end backup pgbackup_pg12-patroni-cluster_20210902.
```

Possible Resolutions

- Another process using CPU causing the backup to slow down
- `base_backup` started on a node that later became unavailable
- The generating cluster isn't in production, but still alerting

Dependencies

- The `base_backup` requires Google Cloud Storage to be available.

Escalation

- Slack channels where help is likely to be found: `#g_infra_database_reliability`

Definitions

- Alert Definition
- Update the template used to format this playbook

Related Links

- [Related alerts](#)
- [PostgreSQL Backup Docs](#)